

Alessandro Colace

+39 349 515 7235 | ale@colace.me | linkedin.com/in/colace | github.com/dokson | colace.me | Milan, Italy

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Forward Deployed Engineer at **Avatar Investments** - **Palantir Preferred Partner**, leading enterprise **Palantir AIP & Foundry** deployments, AI Ontology design, and Mission Engineering workflows. Cloud Data & AI Architect with 15+ years across data engineering, BI, ML platforms, and operations management - spanning telco, insurance, fashion, manufacturing, automotive, retail, mobility, and investments. Pairs scalable architecture with cost-efficient delivery (**70% GCP cost reduction worth €500K+/year**), team leadership (4-10 people, 100% on-time delivery), and operational rigor (Scrum sprints, Lean Manufacturing, Six Sigma Yellow Belt). Equally comfortable architecting enterprise AI platforms and shipping end-to-end customer-facing products. **Selected case studies:** avatar-investments.com · colace.me · [hedge-fund-tracker](https://hedge-fund-tracker.com).

CORE COMPETENCIES

Palantir AIP & Foundry

AI Ontology Design

Mission Engineering

Agentic AI (RAG, MCP, Multi-Agent)

Cloud Data Platforms (GCP, Azure, AWS)

Data Governance & GDPR

Cost Optimization

Team Leadership

WORK EXPERIENCE

Avatar Investments

Jan 2026 - Present

Forward Deployed Engineer - Milan, Italy

*Avatar Investments is a **Palantir Preferred Partner** delivering enterprise AI transformations, with offices in Milan, Istanbul, and Miami.*

- Lead AI solution delivery on **Palantir Foundry & AIP**: AI Ontology design, **Mission Engineering** and **Mission Execution** workflows, translating client business needs into deployed ontologies and data pipelines.
- Designed and authored the firm's internal "**Avatar Method**" playbook - a structured framework (inspired by [8090 Solutions](https://8090solutions.com)) for approaching any new client engagement, from discovery to production hand-off.
- Built and shipped, **solo and in days**, two end-to-end deliverables: the firm's multilingual public website (avatar-investments.com, EN/IT, SEO/GEO-ready) and **Avatar Hub** - an internal platform with **19 live modules** (ATS with M365 provisioning, AI Studio with Deep Research, Partnership CRM, IAM, AI Maturity Index, Certification simulator, and more). Stack: FastAPI · React/Vite/TypeScript · Neon PostgreSQL · Microsoft Graph + Azure AD/MSAL · Anthropic Claude · SharePoint RAG-lite.

COalesCE

Jun 2022 - Jan 2026

Cloud Data & AI Architect - Milan, Italy

*Independent cloud-data consulting practice across Reply group (Go Reply, Cluster Reply), The Information Lab, and Nimbus Intelligence. Selected clients: **Telepass, Campari, Generali, Ferragamo, IEO.***

- Led data teams of 4 to 8 people, implementing Scrum to achieve **100% on-time delivery** for 3 major projects, eliminating missed deadlines.
- Architected a data harmonization framework for a global retail/manufacturing client, unifying data from 30+ providers by resolving inconsistencies in currency, timezones, and product units.
- Developed scalable and cost-efficient cloud data platforms; achieved a **70% cost reduction on GCP saving €500K+ annually**.
- Partnered with senior stakeholders to design a Unified Customer View (UCV) for ~8M customers and a complex ARPU model, integrating diverse revenue and promotions streams.
- Established GDPR-compliant Data Governance framework, integrating Data Catalog and dbt for automated Data Quality checks, improving accuracy, consistency, and timeliness KQIs by ~30%.

Zenkis (Shoes Manufacturing)

Jan 2020 - May 2022

Operations Manager - Kyiv, Ukraine

- Ran end-to-end operations (Sales, HR, Marketing, Production, Procurement, R&D) of a 50+ employee shoes manufacturer.
- Executed a full turnaround strategy: from **€10K/month losses to profitability within 12 months** through Lean Manufacturing, waste reduction, and process optimization.
- Returned to data after the outbreak of the war forced a pivot back from entrepreneurship.

Data Reply

Jan 2017 - Dec 2019

Senior Big Data Architect - Bologna, Italy

- Secured a new retail client from scratch generating **€1M+/year** for Reply Holding (€2B+ revenue, 15k+ employees), personally sourcing 5+ consultants and establishing Reply's new Bologna office.
- Led 2 teams of ~10 people each (Data Viz and Integration + Data Engineering).
- Implemented data solutions within Cloudera Hadoop ecosystems; designed data lake architectures across raw, processing, service, and insights layers, plus first batch and real-time ingestion procedures.
- Collaborated with C-levels to build Tableau KPI dashboards (Unipol, YOOX Net-a-Porter), unifying siloed departments for enhanced visibility and streamlined decisions.

Iconsulting

Oct 2015 - Dec 2016

Business Intelligence Consultant - Casalecchio di Reno (BO), Italy

- Implemented a proactive alerting system for Big Data Analytics within a Tier-1 telco context, using Oracle BI Foundation Suite and Tableau (high-impact Master's thesis).
- Designed data marts in dimensional data modeling (star and snowflake); developed reporting on OBIEE, MS SSAS, and Tableau.
- Enhanced and maintained the company's proprietary Location Intelligence framework using MongoDB, Angular, Leaflet, Kafka, and Node.

Sitech Srl (via Value Team, later NTT Data)

Sep 2008 - Sep 2009

.NET Developer - Bologna, Italy

My first full-time permanent role, taken on straight out of high school (ITIS Belluzzi) and treated as a senior developer from day one.

- Built enterprise applications using ASP.NET MVC (C#), MSSQL stored procedures, and Crystal Reports dashboards, deployed to an integrated rail traffic control system.
- Joined the company at age 18 after exposing a security breach in my school's IT system that drew national media attention; my former CS teacher recruited me directly on the strength of the incident, treating me as a senior-level hire.

Earlier Roles

Jul 2007 - Oct 2015

Sysadmin, Web/E-Commerce, Java & Tutoring (parallel to studies) - Bologna & Ferrara, Italy

- University of Bologna - Computer Engineering Tutor (Nov 2014 - Oct 2015, part-time). 🏆 H-ACK TRAVEL 1st place (Apr 2014, H-FARM Roncade) - our PLAY-n-PLANE app for group travel itineraries won the 24-hour hackathon for Bravofly.
- Unimatica S.p.A. - Java Developer (Jul - Dec 2013): backend components for public-sector digital signature workflows; issued and revoked Infocert and Actalis certificates.
- StarEmilia Srl (Mercedes-Benz dealership) - Solo Sysadmin (Sep 2011 - Feb 2012, part-time): full IT stack ownership.
- Rian Next Abbigliamento - E-Commerce Manager (Jan - Dec 2010, part-time): eBay shop and online retailing for a family-owned fashion clothing store.
- Città Metropolitana di Bologna - Software & Web Intern (Jul - Aug 2007): top-ranked-student summer internship during ITIS Belluzzi studies.

PROJECTS

Hedge Fund Tracker

Full-stack open-source tool for tracking institutional portfolios via SEC filings (13F, 13D/G, Form 4). FastAPI + React/Vite/TypeScript/Tailwind, AI Analyst for stock due diligence (Google AI, OpenAI, Finnhub), Docker + GitHub Pages deployment, automated GitHub Actions for daily SEC EDGAR ingestion.

EDUCATION

Master's Degree in Computer Engineering - University of Bologna

Dec 2013 - Jul 2016

110/110 Summa Cum Laude. Thesis: Design and Implementation of a Proactive Alerting System inside a Big Data Analytics platform.

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Engineering - University of Bologna

Oct 2009 - Jul 2013

Thesis: Design and Implementation of a Tool for the Automatic Segmentation of Video Collections.

Informatics Industrial Engineer - ITIS "O. Belluzzi"

Sep 2003 - Jun 2008

CERTIFICATIONS

Six Sigma Yellow Belt (SSYB) - Council for Six Sigma Certification	2025
Machine Learning Engineer (PMLE) - Google Cloud	2024
Cloud Network Engineer (PCNE) - Google Cloud	2024
Cloud DevOps Engineer (PCDOE) - Google Cloud	2023
Cloud Database Engineer (PCDE) - Google Cloud	2023
Tableau Desktop Specialist (TDS-C01) - Tableau	2018

SKILLS

AI & Agentic: Palantir AIP & Foundry, AI Ontology Design, Mission Engineering, RAG, MCP, Multi-Agent Systems, Vertex AI; LLM tooling (Claude, GPT, Gemini, LLaMA, LangChain, Groq, OpenRouter); automation (n8n, UiPath, Workato, MuleSoft, Zapier, Make.com)

Data & Cloud: GCP, Azure, AWS · dbt, BigQuery, Snowflake, Databricks, ADF, Synapse, Purview, Airflow, Spark, Dataflow, Pub/Sub, Kafka, Cloudera Hive/Impala, Oracle DWH · MLOps / LLMops / DataOps / DevOps / FinOps · Terraform, Docker, Kubernetes

BI & Architecture: Tableau, Power BI, Looker, OBIEE · Data Modeling, Data Governance (GDPR, MDM, Data Catalog, Data Lineage), ETL/ELT, Data Quality, Real-time / Streaming, Microservices, Event-Driven Design

Programming: Python, SQL / PL-SQL, TypeScript, JavaScript, Node.js, Java, PySpark, Scala, Shell, PowerShell, C# / .NET

Methodology & Domain: Scrum / Agile, Lean Manufacturing, Six Sigma, People Management · Industries: Insurance, Telco, Fashion / Luxury, Manufacturing, Automotive, Retail, Mobility, Investments / FinTech, Healthcare

Languages: Italian (native), English (C1, fluent), Russian (limited)